

Albert Ward

Research leader with published work and wide experience in quantitative social science, survey science and public opinion, across academia (LSE, Harvard, Oxford) and industry (BBC, the UN, UK Parliament)

albertjamesward@gmail.com

[in LinkedIn](#) [Website](#)

`</>` R, JavaScript, HTML, Python

[GitHub](#) [Google Scholar](#)

EDUCATION

University of Oxford

DPhil (PhD) Political Science

2021 – 2025

- Thesis uses high-resolution electoral and demographic data, observational and experimental surveys to model neighbourhood-level voting using causal inference techniques. Supervised by Prof. James Tilley
- Designed and fielded original surveys (incl. conjoint experiments) using Qualtrics and Javascript/HTML tools. Secured over £20,000 in external funding
- Completed advanced training in causal inference (matching, DiD, RDD), time series (stationarity, GEC), MRP, machine learning, demography and qualitative interviews
- Focused on survey methods, and post-stratification and weighting adjustment (incl. raking, calibration) in R/Python

Harvard University

Visiting Fellow (PhD student), Dept of Government

2024 – 2025

- Grade: 4.0 GPA. Completed graduate coursework in mathematical statistics, predictive modelling, hierarchical models, research design, and data engineering
- Supervised by Prof. Ryan Enos; presented to workshops on political methodology

London School of Economics

MSc (Hons) Comparative Government

2019 – 2020

- Completed graduate coursework in public and social policy, and panel data methods. Applied fixed effects models to European electoral data in final dissertation project
- Grade: Distinction (top 15%). Supervised by Prof. Sara Hobolt

University of York

BA (Hons) Philosophy, Politics and Economics

2016 – 2019

- Grade: 2:1[69]. Final thesis on the social determinants of inequality

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BBC

London

Elections Analyst

2024 and 2025

- Delivered real-time analysis for the 2024 and 2025 local and general election night programmes, supporting on-air reporting in a high-pressure live environment
- Produced the 2024 election exit poll as part of a small team, the most accurate ever

Jesus College and Hertford College, Oxford

Oxford

Lecturer in Politics

2023 – 2025

- Taught R methods labs to 100 undergraduate students for a 'Political Analysis' course
- Gave lectures and seminars to 300 final-year students on 'Political Sociology', with 96% of students rating teaching as 'excellent' or 'very good' in end-of-term evaluation

United Nations Development Programme

Oxford

Report Author

2023 – 2024

- Designed survey instruments and developed models (incl. post-stratification weighting and raking) for a UN climate report in R, in an international team, based on the largest ever poll of global climate opinions (N = 73,000)
- Co-authored the final report (see [PUBLICATIONS](#)); contributed to publicising it to global media, including articles and promotions

LSE British Politics and Policy

Remote

Writer

2022 – 2023

- Authored four articles on public opinion with an average readership of 3,000+ for the UK's most-read public policy website. Gave interviews to national broadcasters

Dept of Politics and International Relations, Oxford

Oxford

Research Assistant

2021 – 2022

- Fielded original surveys, and developed hierarchical and fixed effects models in R to predict neighbourhood-level political polarisation, as part of a [£400,000 UK Government-funded project](#)
- Contributed modelling and methodological guidance for a forthcoming book on polarisation, under contract with Oxford University Press

House of Commons

London

Parliamentary Researcher

Feb – Dec 2020

- Led and co-wrote a report on voting behaviour in the 2019 election for senior MPs, using multiyear economic data at the constituency level, and conducting qualitative interviews with voters and party members, [reported in national newspapers](#)

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

2025. [Regional spending does not affect support for the European Union](#). Journal of European Public Policy (w/ James Tilley and Sara Hobolt)
2024. [Peoples' Climate Vote](#). New York: United Nations Development Programme (w/ Steve Fisher and others)
2024. [Reproduction and Robustness of Kao et al. \(2024\): 'Female Representation and Legitimacy'](#). Report from UC Berkeley Replication Scheme (w/ Tom Brailey and others)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming languages and tools: R (tidyverse, rmarkdown, survey, glmnet, rvest), Python (pandas, numpy, jupyter, sklearn), Javascript (Qualtrics, surveys), STATA, SPSS

Design and visualisation: HTML/CSS, GIS (ArcGIS and QGIS), Adobe Creative Suite, L^AT_EX